

Group Quote Marketing

Standard Operating Procedure

Document Reference	SOP-INS-007
Version	1.1
Effective Date	15 March 2025
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Owner	Group Marketing & Distribution
Approved By	Chief Marketing Officer
Classification	Internal Use Only
Applicable To	All group insurance marketing activities and group policy quotations issued by Meridian Insurance Group

1. Purpose

This SOP defines the process by which group insurance policies are marketed, quoted, and sold to prospective group clients through field agents and marketing managers. It ensures that group opportunities are consistently identified, qualified, correctly priced, and converted into master policies through a coordinated sales and underwriting process.

2. Scope

This procedure applies to:

- All group insurance sales opportunities with 10 or more proposed covered lives
- Employer-sponsored group life, health, disability, and accident programmes
- Affinity and association group insurance programmes

This procedure does NOT cover: individual product campaigns (refer SOP-INS-001 or SOP-INS-008), wholesale distribution marketing, or reinsurance treaty placements.

3. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
Insurance Representative (Field Agent)	Identifies and qualifies group prospects; collects census and benefits data; presents Meridian solutions; manages client relationship through the sales cycle.
Marketing Manager	Develops and executes group marketing campaigns; creates collateral and proposal materials; coordinates market positioning; tracks pipeline and conversion metrics.
New Business Specialist	Coordinates group quote preparation with Underwriting and Actuarial; prepares formal proposal documents; manages quote validity period and renewal of expired quotes.
Underwriting / Actuarial	Reviews group census data; sets pricing and risk conditions; approves final quote for submission to prospect.

4. Pre-requisites and Triggers

Triggered when a field agent or marketing manager identifies a group prospect with a minimum of 10 eligible members. A completed Group Census Data Form must be received before a formal quote can be prepared.

5. Process Steps

5.1 Prospect Identification and Qualification

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
1	Group prospect identified via campaign, referral, or agent sourcing	Field Agent / Marketing Manager	Prospect logged in CRM; preliminary group size and benefit type recorded
2	Initial meeting / needs discovery	Field Agent	Group needs, current insurer, renewal date, and decision-making timeline established

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
3	Census data request sent to prospect	Field Agent	Meridian Group Census Data Form provided; completion deadline set
4	Completed census data received	Field Agent / New Business Specialist	Data validated for completeness; missing data followed up within 2 business days

5.2 Quote Preparation

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
5	Census data submitted to Underwriting and Actuarial	New Business Specialist	Quote request logged with target presentation date; urgency level assigned
6	Risk assessment and pricing	Underwriting / Actuarial	Experience rating or community rating applied based on group size; pricing completed within 5 business days for standard groups
7	Formal quote document prepared	New Business Specialist	Proposal includes: benefits schedule, premium rates by tier, validity period (30 days), and key terms and conditions
8	Quote reviewed and approved	Marketing Manager / Underwriting	Final review for accuracy and compliance with marketing guidelines; approved quote released to agent

5.3 Presentation and Conversion

#	Activity	Responsible	Output / Notes
9	Proposal presented to prospect	Field Agent	Presentation meeting held; proposal submitted; competitor comparison prepared if requested
10	Prospect negotiation (if applicable)	Field Agent / New Business Specialist	Revised terms submitted to Underwriting for approval; maximum 2 quote revisions permitted without escalation
11	Prospect accepts proposal	Field Agent	Signed acceptance letter or heads of agreement received; accepted in CRM
12	Handover to Group Benefits Administration	New Business Specialist	Case file transferred to SOP-INS-006 for master policy setup

6. Decision Points and Exception Handling

6.1 Prospect Does Not Proceed

- Reason for loss recorded in CRM with standard 'Lost Business' reason codes
- Marketing Manager reviews lost business report monthly to identify pricing or product competitiveness issues
- Agent may request a post-decision debrief with the prospect to understand feedback

6.2 Quote Exceeds Validity Period

- New Business Specialist notifies field agent at 7 days before expiry
- If prospect requires extension: Underwriting re-confirms pricing; extended quote reissued with revised validity date

6.3 Non-Standard Group (High-Risk Industry or Claims History)

- Underwriting flags non-standard groups to Compliance and Head of Group Insurance before quote is prepared
- Pricing loaded with appropriate risk margin; exclusions included as required
- Head of Group Insurance must approve quotes for groups with loss ratios above 80% in prior 3 years

7. Systems and Tools

System / Tool	Purpose	Access
CRM (Salesforce)	Prospect tracking, pipeline management, proposal history	Field Agent, Marketing Manager, New Business Specialist
Group Quotation Tool (Actuarial)	Census data input, pricing calculation, proposal generation	New Business Specialist, Actuarial
Document Management System (SharePoint)	Proposal storage, approved collateral library	All roles
Marketing Automation (HubSpot)	Campaign management, lead generation, email marketing	Marketing Manager
PAS	Handover to policy setup upon acceptance	New Business Specialist

8. Key Performance Indicators

- Group pipeline conversion rate: Minimum 25% of formal quotes convert to bound policies
- Quote preparation cycle time: 100% of standard group quotes prepared within 5 business days of census data receipt
- Quote validity compliance: 100% of quotes presented to prospect within validity period
- Lost business documentation rate: 100% of lost group opportunities recorded in CRM with reason code
- New group premium written: Track against annual target by segment and territory

9. Related Documents

- SOP-INS-006: Group Benefits Administration
- POL-UW-003: Group Underwriting Policy

- POL-MKTG-001: Marketing and Communications Standards
- POL-COMP-004: Product Disclosure and Sales Conduct Policy

10. Document Control and Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
1.0	01 Jun 2023	F. Okonkwo, Group Marketing	Initial release
1.1	15 Mar 2025	F. Okonkwo, Group Marketing	Added non-standard group exception; updated CRM steps; revised conversion KPI targets